

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 10
 ♥ K J 9 7 5 4
 ♦ A
 ♣ 9 5

♠ A 9 5
 ♥ Q 10 2
 ♦ K Q 10 6 3
 ♣ K 8



♠ 6 4 2
 ♥ 8 3
 ♦ 9 7 4
 ♣ J 10 7 4 3

♠ 8 7 3
 ♥ A 6
 ♦ J 8 5 2
 ♣ A Q 6 2

West	North	East	South
1♥	1NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

stopper. He could drive out dummy's ♥A at trick 2, but you would then establish ♦s and make an overtrick!

But who said West would play another ♥ after winning the ♥K? What if he wins the ♥K and switches to ♠s? They might then win 3 ♠ tricks to go with their ♥K and ♦A.

Instead you should grab the first trick with dummy's ♥A and start playing ♦s. West will take the ♦A but you still have the ♠A and ♥Q as stoppers.

Just look at West's hand. If you duck the ♥A it will be crystal clear to him that he can defeat the contract by winning the ♥K and then switching to the ♠K.

Don't give him the chance.

You should not make a takeout double with three cards in their suit. A 2♦ overcall would be a reasonable choice. But with 15 points, balanced, and a stopper in ♥s a 1NT overcall is probably better.

Partner bids 3NT.

North plays 3NT. As expected, East leads his partner's ♥ suit.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 1/2 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 5/6

You need at least 4 ♦ winners.

If you play low from dummy on the ♥ lead West can win the ♥K but this will give you an extra ♥

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 2
 ♥ K 8 3
 ♦ 10 8 5 4
 ♣ Q 10 6 2

♠ K 6 3

♥ A 10 5

♦ A 7 6 2

♣ A 7 5



♠ A Q J 9 7 4

♥ -

♦ K Q J 3

♣ J 8 3

♠ 8 5

♥ Q J 9 7 6 4 2

♦ 9

♣ K 9 4

West

North

East

South

1NT

2♠

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

help you, so it is more logical to play West for the ♥K. But if West does have the ♥K it will do you no good to ruff East's ♠A, West will over-ruff and you would still have that ♣ loser.

So do it this way instead. Discard the ♣ loser on East's ♠A! Another ♠ from East won't hurt you since dummy would be able to over-ruff West. Whatever East plays you can win, then finesse West out of his ♥K.

It was said earlier that you didn't have a winner on which you could discard the ♣ loser.

That was true, so instead you were able to discard it on a loser!

You would really like to have a transfer bid in this situation, to make North bid ♥s.

But you don't have one, so you just bid 4♥ yourself.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♠10. You play low in dummy and West holds the trick. He continues the suit and East takes the ♠Q and then plays the ♠A.

Loser List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 4

You've already lost the 2 ♠s. If West has the ♥K you might avoid a loser there. You don't have a winner on which to discard the ♣ loser.

If East has the ♥K it will have to be a singleton to help you, so it is more logical to play West for the ♥K. But if West does have the ♥K it will do you no good to ruff East's ♠A, West will over-ruff and you would still have that ♣ loser.